

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ 7

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣ 10

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥ 5

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 7 3

♥ 4

♦ Q 10 4 2

♣ A Q 10 3

♠ K 5

♥ A K 10 7 5 3

♦ K 7

♣ J 9 6



♠ Q J 6

♥ 9 2

♦ J 5

♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

♠ A 8 4 2

♥ Q J 8 6

♦ A 9 8 6 3

♣ -

SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by North			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ -
 ♥ A 9 7 5
 ♦ K 9 8 6 4
 ♣ J 9 3 2

♠ A J 9 8 6 4

♥ 8 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 5 3
 ♥ K Q J 10 3
 ♦ A
 ♣ K Q 10 6

♠ Q 10 7 2

♥ 4 2

♦ Q J 5 3 2

♣ 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♥
 6♥
 All Pass
 6♥ by East
 Lead: ♣7

Pass
 Pass

1♥
 4NT

Pass
 Pass

EAST figures that if WEST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

WEST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

EAST manages to figure out that WEST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10 9 4
♣ 10 9 8

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4



♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3

SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♠

Pass

1♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♣10

4♠

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ -
 ♥ K Q J 8 6 3
 ♦ K J 2
 ♣ A Q 6 5

♠ K J 8 6

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 7 6 3

♣ 10 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 7 5 3

♥ 10 9 4 2

♦ A 8

♣ K J 4

♠ A 10 9 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ 10 5 4

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♥5			

WEST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and EAST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that EAST holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!